



STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Rinkd LLC × Nickel City Hockey Tournaments

FOR Matt Peters, Founder · Nickel City Hockey
FROM Rinkd LLC
DATE May 2026

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & SHARED VISION

Operators like Nickel City have the tournament logistics down — scoring, scheduling, brackets, registration all running on platforms that work. What's missing is the off-ice **community layer** that turns a tournament weekend into a 52-week relationship with your families.

Rinkd LLC proposes a strategic partnership to add that layer on top of Nickel City's existing operations — **without touching what already works**. Players, parents, and coaches get a digital "locker room" for each tournament; Nickel City stays the brand they remember between events.

We're proposing this on a **Founding Tournament Partner** basis: no cash exchange in year one, a balanced value swap, with a clearly named graduation path for the years that follow.

2. MUTUAL VALUE EXCHANGE

This is **not a software giveaway**. Both sides bring real value. The marketing commitments in Section 3 are the consideration for the software — no cash moves, but the exchange is balanced.

What Nickel City gets (year one)

- **Co-branded tournament hubs** inside Rinkd for every Nickel City tournament — schedules, live standings, brackets, team pages, player profiles.
- **The Digital Locker Room:** team chat (no group-text chaos), photo/highlight wall, live recap pushes after every game, pinned schedule changes that reach every parent's phone, postseason awards roll-up.
- **Tech-forward brand position** — first-mover among comparable operators in the region. Differentiated from every other tournament a family chooses between.
- **Direct ongoing input** into the Rinkd product roadmap. Features we build for Nickel City ship for everyone, but you get them first.

What Rinkd gets (distribution)

- **Founding Tournament Partner status** — recognition as Nickel City's digital community platform.
- **Organic user acquisition** via the marketing channels in Section 3. **Critical clarification: Rinkd does NOT receive Nickel City's customer email lists, registration databases, or any pre-collected PII.** All user relationships are opt-in via Rinkd's own app signup flow when participants download from Nickel City's channels.
- **Co-branded marketing inventory** across the tournament lifecycle.

- **Post-event testimonial** from Matt + permission to use the Nickel City Hockey logo and Matt Peters' name in Rinkd marketing. Introductions to peer tournament operators in Matt's network are welcome but not required.

3. SHARED MARKETING & DISTRIBUTION

To make the value exchange work, Nickel City commits the following marketing surfaces to Rinkd through the 2026-27 season:

- **Digital integration:** Rinkd download link + tournament call-to-action included in pre-tournament email blasts, registration confirmations, and captain packets.
- **Web + social presence:** "Download Rinkd for live updates and team chat" banner on tournament landing pages; co-branded social announcements before each event weekend.
- **On-site visibility:** Rinkd QR-code signage at check-in tables, rink lobbies, and digital displays where available.

Brand pairing convention:

- On Rinkd surfaces for Nickel City events **Nickel City Hockey Tournaments** branding + logo lead.
- On Nickel City surfaces for Rinkd **"Powered by Rinkd · Digital Locker Room."**
- Mutual approval required for any third-party use of either logo.

4. SEAMLESS USER ONBOARDING WORKFLOW

Designed for zero operational friction for Nickel City staff and a flawless experience for participants:

- **Roster + schedule handoff:** roughly two weeks before each tournament, Nickel City emails Rinkd two files — the team list and the schedule. **Total staff effort: sending the files.**
- **Pre-populated data:** Rinkd builds the tournament hub, team pages, brackets, and schedules. Everything is live before day one.
- **Team profile claim (encouraged, not required):** at check-in, team managers and captains are invited to claim their team's Rinkd profile. The incentive does the work — claiming unlocks team chat, live recap pushes, the photo wall, pinned schedule changes, and the postseason awards summary. It stays outside Nickel City's critical-path operations.
- **Player + parent invites:** managers invite their roster + parent group via one link. The weekend's social features unlock automatically.

Scaling note: for the first tournament (and possibly the second), Rinkd handles the data mapping manually. A self-serve GameSheet importer ships before mid-season — **by your third tournament the data handoff is one click on Nickel City's side.**

Non-tech parents are not left out. The public tournament landing (schedules, scores, brackets) remains fully accessible without downloading the app. The Rinkd app unlocks the social/community layer; it never gates the core tournament experience.

5. SUCCESS METRICS

So both sides know what worked, we'll jointly track after each tournament:

- **Adoption:** ≥ 50% of teams claim their Rinkd profile · ≥ 30% of participating players + parents create an account.
- **Engagement:** average of 5+ posts/chirps per team across the weekend · 80%+ of recap pushes successfully delivered to opted-in subscribers.
- **Brand:** a one-question post-event survey to participants ("Did Rinkd add to your tournament experience?") with results shared both ways.

Targets reassessed each tournament. If metrics aren't tracking after two tournaments, either side raises it – and we adapt or unwind cleanly per Section 6.

6. TERM, RENEWAL, AND THE MOU

Founding Tournament Partner status: 2026-27 season (\$0 software fee).

In exchange for the Section 3 marketing commitments, Rinkd waives software fees for every Nickel City tournament during the 2026-27 season. Status reassessed for 2027-28 with **Founding-Partner Annual pricing locked at a discount to the public rate** (currently \$1,500/yr for unlimited tournaments + leagues + off-season feed) – for as long as the partnership renews.

MOU terms: short, plain-language, one page. Mutual 30-day termination notice from either side. No exclusivity on either side. Data ownership stays with whoever originates it (Nickel City owns its registration + team data; Rinkd owns its app account + engagement data). The Founding-Partner discount carries through any renewal.

NEXT STEPS

If these terms align with Nickel City's goals for the upcoming season, we'll finalize the one-page MOU and begin data integration for your next scheduled tournament. **We'd welcome the chance to prove the model on a single tournament before discussing anything broader.**

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